the prize in the presence of President Yitzhak Navon a few hours later. This was another right, this was another time, and, let's admit it, this was another Israel—or, more exactly, another Israel in power.

Tuesday, April 11

Last week, Bogie Ya'alon, ex-chief of staff and defense minister, explained it most coherently: Dov Lior, Smotrich's and Ben-Gvir's rabbi, was also years ago the rabbi of those Jewish underground members who, among other glorious deeds, planned to murder Arab mayors and blow up Al-Aqsa, and were arrested at the last moment by the Shin Bet. Their plan was to precipitate the "final war" as the ultimate moment of the messianic process, the war that would bring about the coming of the messiah. Nice people. But now our two jokers are important ministers in Israel's government and, who knows? Dov Lior may still be their rabbi.

Incidentally, Dov Lior, the author of any number of racist statements and a steady inciter of violence against Arabs, dedicated a book of his to Baruch Goldstein, the murderer of twenty-nine Arabs at prayer in the Cave of the Patriarchs mosque. Ben-Gvir had a portrait of Goldstein hanging in his living room for years, until the recent elections. As I said, nice people.

Netanyahu decided to continue the policy of forbidding the access of Jews to the Temple Mount during the last ten days of Ramadan. Ben-Gvir objected strenuously, calling it "giving in to terror," "a security scandal," and "forsaking the lives of the worshippers at the Western Wall." For once, the crazy zealot didn't get the last word. For once. Netanyahu, please continue and, if you can, please throw him out. And Smotrich too.

Thursday, April 13